

Character Profile

Build a person, not a list of traits.

01 The triangle: wound, want, need The wound creates the want. The story exists to force the need.

WOUND

The old injury they never talk about. It happened before page one.

WANT

The concrete goal they chase. This one they can name out loud.

NEED

The truth that would actually heal them. They cannot see it yet.

02 Identity Just enough to hold them steady on the page.

NAME _____ ROLE IN STORY _____ AGE _____

ONE-LINE ESSENCE _____

03 Voice If you covered the dialogue tags, could a reader still tell it is them?

HOW THEY SPEAK _____

VERBAL TICS _____

04 Arc The distance between the first box and the last box is your story.

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

THE TRUTH THEY NEED

STATE IN THE FIRST SCENE

STATE IN THE LAST SCENE

05 Relationships Characters are defined by what they want from each other.

PERSON

WHAT THEY WANT FROM THEM

FRICTION
